ENG 2003 - Effective Engineering Communication

<u>Term Project 02</u> - Communication Portfolio (20% of final grade)

Due: April 13th, 2026 (11:59pm)

<u>Summary:</u> For Term Project 2, you will create a communication portfolio. This document (1) identifies the associated learning outcome; (2) offers guidelines and instructions for each section of the portfolio; (3) provides an overview of how the project will be assessed including a rubric; and (4) suggests platforms you can use to create your portfolio, along with resources you may find helpful when completing your portfolio.

<u>1. Learning Outcome</u>: Analyze and identify your own communication skills as an engineer, identifying gaps and opportunities for improvement (CLO7).

<u>2. Guidelines/Instructions:</u> This semester, you have been asked to complete a variety of activities, exercises, and assignments in this course. This is your opportunity to showcase and reflect on your best work, and to identify the communication skills you developed along the way. Your portfolio should be a stand-alone record that can be understood by someone other than your classmates, TAs, or instructors.

Your portfolio can be either publicly available (website) or can be privately but with access (e.g. password) provided to the instructional team as part of your submission. You should ensure that the instructional team can <u>access it at least until May 31st, 2026, if not longer.</u> You may use any platform of your choosing to build and host your portfolio - some platform suggestions have been provided below). Submit your completed portfolio by <u>11:59pm, April 13, 2026</u>, via the Term Project 02 page on eClass.

In short, your portfolio should

i. showcase your work;
ii. reflect on your development as a communicator;
iii. be linked to a LinkedIn profile;
iv. be uniquely tailored to you; and
v. make a positive, professional impression.

<u>i. Showcase:</u> Select four (4) items which, in your opinion, best reflect your skills and your development as an effective communicator. Three (3) items must be from ENG2003, and one (1) must be a communications-related work from another course or activity (e.g. hackathon, conference etc). All showcased work should have been completed during the current academic year (i.e., 2023-2024).

For each item in your showcase, you should address the following:

- Explain why you selected this piece for your showcase
- What does this piece say about your development as a communicator?
- Did this piece push you out of your comfort zone?

- Is this piece your best work? Why or why not?

NOTE: If you are not comfortable with sharing the actual showcase(s) as downloadable attachments, then you may wish to post samples or section of it as images instead.

ii. Reflection: By drawing on the Axioms of Communication, the 7 C's, and the resources provided below, reflect on your experiences in the course as well as your development as a communicator. Your reflection should demonstrate reflective thought and inquiry, in addition to providing examples from, and making connections to your personal experiences. This section should consist of two parts: (I) reflections on your experiences in ENG2003; and (II) reflections on your growth and development as an effective communicator. In total, this section should be between **500 and 1,000 words** in length.

Here are some questions to consider when reflecting on your experiences in ENG2003 (remember to provide examples):

- How would you describe your overall experience in ENG2003?
- Was the course what you expected it to be? Why or why not?
- Which course content did you find the most useful and why?
- Which topic(s) did you find the most interesting and why?

Here are some questions to consider when reflecting on your development as a communicator (remember to provide examples):

- How would you describe your communication abilities *before* ENG2003? What about now?
- Which communication skills (e.g., presentations, report writing, etc.) did you improve the most?
- Which communication skills do you still need to work on?
- How will your experience in this course change the way you approach other engineering courses? What about engineering practice?

iii. LinkedIn: By drawing on the course content concerning cover letters and resumes, and using the LinkedIn Profile Checklist (available on eClass), create a LinkedIn profile (or update your existing profile using the guidelines outlined below). Ensure that your LinkedIn profile is prominently linked in your portfolio, and that your LinkedIn profile includes a link to your portfolio. **To receive marks for your profile, it must be visible to the public** (consult the tutorial available on eClass if you're not sure how to do this).

At minimum, your LinkedIn profile should include the following:

- A descriptive headline (e.g., "Third-Year Mechanical Engineering Student");
- A clear, concise summary (don't forget the 7 C's);
- Under education: provide details about your undergraduate program; and
- Under skills & experience: list at least five skills.

iv. Uniquely Tailored: Your portfolio should be uniquely tailored to you as both an emerging professional engineer and as a person. Consider including select hobbies or extracurricular activities, and explain how these activities allowed you to develop transferable skills. Crucially, you should use your judgement to balance personalization on the one hand, and professionalism on the other.

This section should include at least one interesting passion-project you worked on, whether in your spare time or in another course. Some examples include:

- Photograph of a prototype you are working on;
- Screenshot of an interface;
- Description or picture of a design project; and
- Description of (and link to) code on github, or your models/drawings on CAD.

v. Positive, Professional Impression: Your portfolio should make a positive impression on the reader without sacrificing professionalism. Consider, for instance, whether your hobbies or extracurriculars are appropriate for a professional portfolio.

You should make an effort to account for the 7 C's throughout your portfolio. For example:

- Have you been clear and concise without sacrificing completeness?
- Do you come across as a credible, courteous person?
- Is your reflection coherent?

3. Assessment Overview: The communication portfolio is worth **20% of your final grade**, a breakdown of which is as follows:

Showcase four pieces of work	40%
Reflection on course, development	30%
LinkedIn profile	10%
Uniquely tailored	10%
Positive, professional impression	10%

4. Platform Suggestions and Additional Resources: To create your portfolio, you may use any platform of your choosing. Your portfolio can be either publicly available (website) or can be privately but with access (e.g. password) provided to the instructional team as part of your submission. You should ensure that the instructional team can access it at least until May 31st, 2026, if not longer.

Keep in mind that many platforms will impose restrictions on free accounts, and that this may prove problematic in the context of this term project. For this reason, it is recommended that you use one of the platforms suggested below.

- Google Sites: https://sites.google.com/
- Wordpress: https://wordpress.com/support/portfolios/
- Wix: https://www.wix.com/portfolio-website
- Crevado: https://crevado.com/create-online-portfolio/basic

Tutorials for creating a portfolio in Wordpress and Wix are available on eClass. You may also find the below resources (which are available on eClass) useful when completing your portfolio:

Gibbs Reflective Cycle (you may find this useful if you are struggling with the reflection section): https://www.ed.ac.uk/reflection/reflectors-toolkit/reflecting-on-experience/gibbs-reflective-cycle

A number of additional reflection models and frameworks can be found here: https://www.eng.mcmaster.ca/resources/instructor-reflection-toolkit#Models-Frameworks

LinkedIn Profile Checklist: contains guidance for completing your LinkedIn profile: https://university.linkedin.com/content/dam/university/global/en_US/site/pdf/LinkedIn_Sample_Profile_onesheet-David.pdf

5. AI Disclosure: It is well understood and accepted that generative AI is a transformative technology that will revolutionize the way we conduct professional and personal business including communicating with others. At the same time, it is self-evident that developing effective professional communication skills including writing emails, documents, reports etc. comes with practice of the art, and requires experiencing critical thinking, cognitive rigour, logical reasoning, and lots of feedback and reflection. In ENG2003, we prefer and recommend that students avoid the use of generative AI tools (e.g. ChatGPT, Bard/Bing, Dall-E etc) and instead formulate their own expressions of professional communications.

However, in the spirit of innovation and not being an impediment to change and new technologies, we will accept the final report and its associated phases created with the assistance of such generative AI tools, provided that the students openly disclose that such tools were used, AND follow these specific instructions:

- Students must not wholly rely on the use of AI and must ensure they are making appropriate edits to the AI-generated text and/or images.
- Disclose the use of AI with a 200 word (min) or more statement in a new page at the end of each deliverable.
- In the statement, mention the process of how you used AI to research/generate your content, and also what edits and/or improvements you have made.
- Include screenshots and/or other evidence (example cases) documenting your process of AI use and improvement.
- The AI disclosure statement must not be prepared using generative AI. It is a student's responsibility to ensure this statement is written in their own words and in a more personal and reflective manner.

Failure to disclose the use of AI tools will be considered a breach of academic integrity and will result in a failure in the assignment and reporting to the Academic Integrity office in Lassonde.

NOTE: For term project 2, the AI disclosure statement should be submitted as a separate document as part of your submission package on eClass.

6. Submission to TurnItIn: Submit the written portions of the showcase descriptions AND reflection to TurnItIn submission link on eClass. Don't worry about formatting here. You can upload your document as a .doc or .pdf file. **A 20% penalty will apply for students missing a TurnItIn submission**. Be sure to follow the correct naming convention for filename AND TurnItIn title:
e.g. FirstName_LastName_ENG2003W24_TermProject2.pdf

7. Submission to eClass Assignment: Submit the portfolio access link/URL and any other relevant information (e.g. access instructions) to the eClass Assignment Submission link in the Term Project 2 section on the course website. The instructional team will only grade the content on the single URL provided, so make sure every section of it is complete and accessible. Be sure to follow the correct naming convention for any file names being submitted:
e.g. FirstName_LastName_ENG2003W24_TermProject2_FileDescription.pdf

Rubric:

Showcase	/40
Reflection	/30
LinkedIn profile	/10
Uniquely tailored	/10
Positive, professional impression	/10
Total	**/100**

Showcases* (40 marks)

***Note: Three of the selected works must be from ENG 2003. The fourth work must be a communications-related work from another course or activity (e.g. hackathon, conference presentation etc), but it should have been completed this year (2025-2026).**

Criteria	**Showcase 1 (ENG 2003)**	**Showcase 2 (ENG 2003)**	**Showcase 3 (ENG 2003)**	**Showcase 4* (Other)**
Explained why the piece was chosen	/3	/3	/3	/3
Explained how the piece reflects the student's development as a communicator	/2	/2	/2	/2
Piece showcases the student's communication skills	/2	/2	/2	/2
Piece was effectively communicated	/3	/3	/3	/3
Total	**/10**	**/10**	**/10**	**/10**

Comments:

Reflections (30 marks)

Part A – Overall Course Reflection (250+ words)	
Student describes, in clear natural language, with the help of 3+ examples, a) their overall experience in ENG 2003; b) whether the course was in line with their expectations; c) the course content they found the most useful; and d) the topic they found most interesting.	/7
Student demonstrates an understanding of the axioms of communication.	/4
Student evidently applied the 7 C's and/or one of the provided reflection frameworks.	/4
Total	**/15**

Part B – Personal Growth/Development (250+ words)	
Student describes, with the help of 3+ examples, a) the extent to which their communication skills improved through ENG 2003; b) which communication skills they improved the most; c) which communication skills they still need to work on; and d) how the course will affect the way they approach other courses (and/or engineering practice).	/7
Student demonstrates an understanding of the axioms of communication.	/4
Student evidently applied the 7 C's and/or one of the provided reflection frameworks.	/4
Total	**/15**

Comments:

LinkedIn Profile (10 marks)

Descriptive headline	/1
Clear, concise summary	/1
Education includes current undergraduate program	/1
Five skills listed	/1
LinkedIn profile was easy to find on portfolio	/1
Content and professionalism	/5
Total	**/10**

Comments:

Uniquely Tailored (10 marks)

Hobbies and interests are presented in a visually compelling way (e.g., original use of figures, layout)	/5
Articulates how the hobbies and interests demonstrate transferrable skills.	/5
Total	**/10**

Comments:

Professionalism and Overall Impression (10 marks)

Overall impression of the portfolio	/5
The portfolio is neatly structured, professional, and easy to follow	/5
Total	**/10**

Comments: